



A spokesperson for the airline told *Business Today* that the airline has voluntarily undertaken enhanced pre-flight safety checks on all its Boeing 787 and Boeing 777 aircraft. It has also completed precautionary inspections of the fuel control switch (FCS) locking mechanism on all Boeing 787 and Boeing 737 aircraft, well within the timeline set by the DGCA. Experts say this is a start.

HARD CALLS

Tata Sons' chairman N Chandrababhan has acknowledged the crash is a "grave setback" for

Air India's comeback narrative. As a stakeholder puts it, corporate turnarounds are hard; airline turnarounds are more complex, and recovering from a high-profile disaster is the hardest. The Tata Group, which owns Air India, has been trying to put its house in order.

Tata Sons and its joint venture partner, Singapore Airlines, have poured in fresh capital totalling ₹9,558 crore in FY25 alone, with ₹6,333 crore coming in from the foreign airline. This represents the largest single-year capital infusion in the history of Indian aviation. Singapore Airlines owns a 25.1%

stake in Air India.

In 2023, Air India placed a record-breaking order for 470 aircraft, followed by another 100 Airbus jets in 2024, bringing its total order book to 570 aircraft. The earlier order for 470 aircraft was worth \$70 billion. The orders include a mix of narrow-body and wide-body aircraft, with a focus on the Airbus A320neo family and A350-900, as well as Boeing 737 MAX, 777-300ER, and 787-9.

Air India has also committed over \$400 million to retrofit 67 of its legacy aircraft, with new interiors and next-generation in-flight

THE TAKEOFF PLAN



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ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

► IT HAS INVESTED \$200 MILLION TO REVAMP ITS ENTIRE IT INFRASTRUCTURE, REPLACING OLD SYSTEMS

► THE AIRLINE IS SETTING UP AN ACADEMY FOR PILOTS, CABIN CREW, ENGINEERS, AND GROUND STAFF

► TATA SONS AND ITS JOINT VENTURE PARTNER, SINGAPORE AIRLINES, POURED IN FRESH CAPITAL TOTALLING ₹9,558 CRORE IN FY25 ALONE

► AIR INDIA HAS ALSO COMMITTED OVER \$400 MILLION TO RETROFIT 67 LEGACY AIRCRAFT

► OF THAT, ₹6,333 CRORE IS COMING FROM SINGAPORE AIRLINES ALONE

► IT IS IN THE PROCESS OF SETTING UP AN MRO FACILITY IN BENGALURU TO HANDLE BOTH NARROWBODY AND WIDEBODY AIRCRAFT